

not consistently select Ashwin to play in England, South Africa, and Australia, which has always perplexed me. With Ravindra Jadeja bowling in tandem, India could have had these two in every match. Ashwin has consistently picked wickets on every surface he has played on. So to typecast him as a spinner, mostly in subcontinent conditions, is not fair.

A good-quality batter or bowler should be able to adapt, and Ashwin has, even though he has not had the opportunity to play in those matches consistently. Otherwise, he would have been far ahead of everyone else in terms of his wicket-taking ability. Ashwin always gave enough indications about his hunger and ability to run through batting line-ups.

You must be a high-quality bowler to pick wickets on any pitch, right? Whether it's aiding you or not, you set such high standards in India because there is help for the spinner. India took great advantage of preparing such pitches for a few years, but you need the skills to score runs or take wickets.

Outside India, the conditions

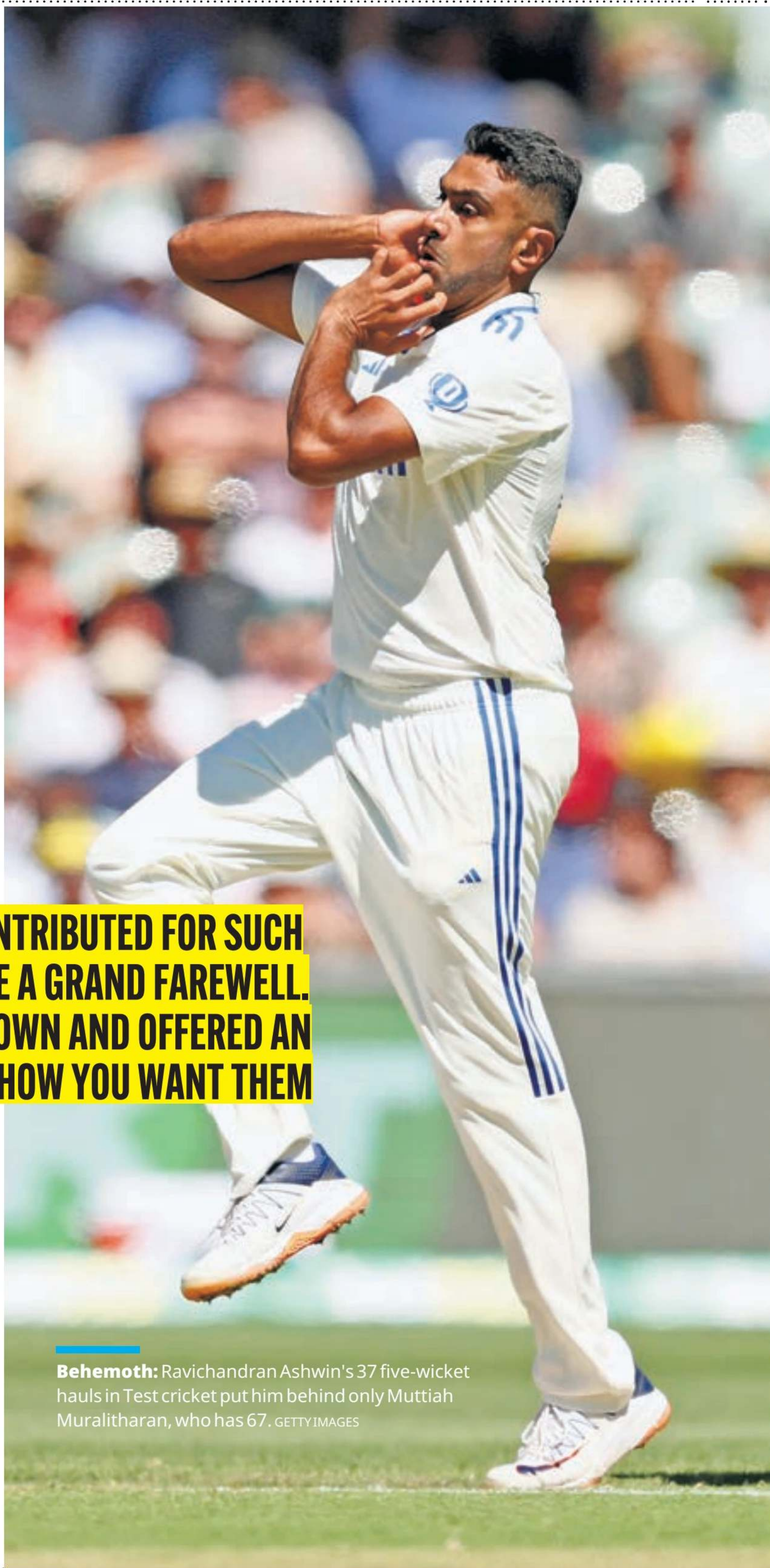


PLAYERS WHO HAVE CONTRIBUTED FOR SUCH A LONG PERIOD DESERVE A GRAND FAREWELL. THEY NEED TO BE SAT DOWN AND OFFERED AN APPROPRIATE PLAN ON HOW YOU WANT THEM TO LEAVE THE GAME



mostly favour the faster bowlers, at least in the first innings, and then slowly, it starts getting better for batting. Ashwin is a class act, and India missed the trick by not consistently giving him those opportunities. He is a thinking cricketer and would have adapted.

I preferred bowling with the new ball. I had the seam upright, the ball



Behemoth: Ravichandran Ashwin's 37 five-wicket hauls in Test cricket put him behind only Muttiah Muralitharan, who has 67. GETTY IMAGES